

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1117

By White

A RESOLUTION to honor Dr. Sidney A. McPhee on the occasion of his retirement as president of Middle Tennessee State University.

WHEREAS, Dr. Sidney A. McPhee, the tenth president of Middle Tennessee State University (MTSU), has presided over one of the most remarkable periods of growth and progress in the institution's more than 110 years of service; and

WHEREAS, Dr. McPhee is retiring from the presidency in December 2026 after more than twenty-five years of distinguished service to the university; after taking a two-semester sabbatical, he will join the College of Education as a tenured professor; and

WHEREAS, since Dr. McPhee's presidency began in 2001, MTSU has been successful in completing almost \$2 billion in improvements in academic, athletic, and campus facilities, including the School of Concrete and Construction Management, Academic Classroom Building for the College of Behavioral and Health Sciences, Science Corridor of Innovation, Applied Engineering Building, and Stephen and Denise Smith Student-Athlete Performance Center; and

WHEREAS, as the leader of Tennessee's largest locally governed university, Dr. McPhee has solidified and enhanced MTSU's reputation for offering the greatest return on investment in Tennessee higher education as the top provider of college graduates to the greater Nashville economy; the third-largest producer of college graduates in the State; and a destination of choice for first-generation students and transfer students; and

WHEREAS, during Dr. McPhee's presidency, MTSU has been successful in raising admission standards, resulting in an increase in enrollment of high-ability students, and he has overseen the addition of some fifty undergraduate and graduate degree programs, two colleges, and twenty institutes and centers; and

WHEREAS, Dr. McPhee has strengthened MTSU's international initiatives on the Murfreesboro campus and abroad through forty university partnerships in seventeen different countries and the enrollment of more international students than any other university in the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Dr. McPhee earned his bachelor's degree from Prairie View A&M University, graduating *summa cum laude*; a master's degree from the University of Miami, Coral Gables, Florida; and a doctorate in applied behavioral studies in education from Oklahoma State University; and

WHEREAS, his work as an academic has appeared in numerous local, national, and international professional journals; his scholarly pursuits include international lectures and presentations in numerous countries, including China, Japan, South Korea, Israel, Belgium, Canada, England, Brazil, Ethiopia, Kenya, and the Bahamas; and

WHEREAS, Dr. McPhee was recently elected to a third term on the NCAA Division I Board of Directors, representing Conference USA; he has previously served on the NCAA Executive Committee; and

WHEREAS, Dr. McPhee has received numerous awards and accolades during his exemplary career; he was named Outstanding American University President by the American Football Foundation in 2002 and honored among Tennessee's 100 Most Powerful People by the *Nashville Post* in 2003 and the State's Top 50 Most Powerful African Americans by *Business Tennessee* in 2004; and

WHEREAS, Dr. McPhee was married to his wife, retired educator Elizabeth McPhee, for forty-five years before her passing and has two adult children, Dr. Seneca McPhee and Dr. Sidney-Anthony McPhee; and

WHEREAS, for more than a quarter-century, Dr. Sidney McPhee has worked to continue the progress and success of Middle Tennessee State University as its president, a position he humbly calls "the great honor of my professional life"; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor Dr. Sidney A. McPhee on the occasion of his retirement as president of Middle Tennessee State University, thank him for more than twenty-five years of dedicated service to the university, and extend to him our best wishes for continued success in his future academic endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.